

Berean Standard Bible

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The Letter to the **Galatians**

Paul's Greeting to the Galatians

1 Paul, an apostle — sent not from men nor by man, but by Jesus Christ and God the Father, who raised Him from the dead — ²and all the brothers with me,

To the churches of Galatia:

³Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ,^a ⁴who gave Himself for our sins to rescue us from the present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father, ⁵to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen.

No Other Gospel

⁶I am amazed how quickly you are deserting the One who called you by the grace of Christ and are turning to a different gospel — ⁷which is not even a gospel. Evidently some people are troubling you and trying to distort the gospel of Christ.

⁸But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach a gospel contrary to the one we preached to you, let him be under a curse! ⁹As we have said before, so now I say again: If anyone is preaching to you a gospel contrary to the one you received, let him be under a curse!

Paul Preaches the Gospel

¹⁰Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ. ¹¹For I want

you to know, brothers, that the gospel I preached was not devised by man.^b ¹²I did not receive it from any man, nor was I taught it; rather, I received it by revelation from Jesus Christ.

¹³For you have heard of my former way of life in Judaism, how severely I persecuted the church of God and tried to destroy it. ¹⁴I was advancing in Judaism beyond many of my contemporaries and was extremely zealous for the traditions of my fathers.

¹⁵But when God, who set me apart from my mother's womb and called me by His grace, was pleased ¹⁶to reveal His Son in me so that I might preach Him among the Gentiles, I did not rush to consult with flesh and blood, ¹⁷nor did I go up to Jerusalem to the apostles who came before me, but I went into Arabia and later returned to Damascus.

¹⁸Only after three years did I go up to Jerusalem to confer with Cephas,^c and I stayed with him fifteen days. ¹⁹But I saw none of the other apostles except James, the Lord's brother. ²⁰I assure you before God that what I am writing to you is no lie.

²¹Later I went to the regions of Syria and Cilicia. ²²I was personally unknown, however, to the churches of Judea that are in Christ. ²³They only heard the account: "The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the faith he once tried

^a 1:3 SBL, BYZ, and TR *God the Father and our Lord Jesus Christ*

^b 1:11 Literally *not according to man*

^c 1:18 That is, Peter

to destroy.” ²⁴ And they glorified God because of me.

The Council at Jerusalem

(Acts 15:5–21)

2 Fourteen years later I went up again to Jerusalem, accompanied by Barnabas. I took Titus along also. ² I went in response to a revelation and set before them the gospel that I preach among the Gentiles. But I spoke privately to those recognized as leaders, for fear that I was running or had already run in vain. ³ Yet not even Titus, who was with me, was compelled to be circumcised, even though he was a Greek.

⁴ This issue arose because some false brothers had come in under false pretenses to spy on our freedom in Christ Jesus, in order to enslave us. ⁵ We did not give in to them for a moment, so that the truth of the gospel would remain with you.

⁶ But as for the highly esteemed—whatever they were makes no difference to me; God does not show favoritism^a—those leaders added nothing to me. ⁷ On the contrary, they saw that I had been entrusted to preach the gospel to the uncircumcised, just as Peter had been to the circumcised. ⁸ For the One who was at work in Peter’s apostleship to the circumcised was also at work in my apostleship to the Gentiles.

⁹ And recognizing the grace that I had been given, James, Cephas,^b and John — those reputed to be pillars — gave me and Barnabas the right hand of fellowship, so that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcised. ¹⁰ They only asked us to remember the poor, the very thing I was eager to do.

Paul Confronts Cephas

¹¹ When Cephas came to Antioch, however, I opposed him to his face, because he stood condemned. ¹² For before certain men came from James, he used to eat with the Gentiles. But when they arrived, he began to draw back and separate himself, for fear of those in the circumcision group. ¹³ The other Jews joined him in his hypocrisy, so that by their hypocrisy even Barnabas was led astray.

¹⁴ When I saw that they were not walking in line with the truth of the gospel, I said to Cephas in front of them all, “If you, who are a Jew, live like a Gentile and not like a Jew, how can you compel the Gentiles to live like Jews?”^c

¹⁵ We who are Jews by birth and not Gentile “sinners” ¹⁶ know that a man is not justified by works of the law, but by faith in Jesus Christ. So we, too, have believed in Christ Jesus, that we may be justified by faith in Christ and not by works of the law, because by works of the law no one will be justified.

¹⁷ But if, while we seek to be justified in Christ, we ourselves are found to be sinners, does that make Christ a minister of sin? Certainly not! ¹⁸ If I rebuild what I have already torn down, I prove myself to be a lawbreaker.

¹⁹ For through the law I died to the law so that I might live to God. ²⁰ I have been crucified with Christ, and I no longer live, but Christ lives in me. The life I live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave Himself up for me. ²¹ I do not set aside the grace of God.

^a 2:6 Literally *God does not accept the face of man*

^b 2:9 That is, Peter; also in verses 11 and 14

^c 2:14 Some translators close this quotation after verse 16 or 21.

For if righteousness comes through the law, then Christ died for nothing.

Faith and Belief

(James 2:14–26)

3O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you? Before your very eyes Jesus Christ was clearly portrayed as crucified. ²I would like to learn just one thing from you: Did you receive the Spirit by works of the law, or by hearing with faith?

³Are you so foolish? After starting in the Spirit, are you now finishing in the flesh?

⁴Have you suffered so much for nothing, if it really was for nothing? ⁵Does God lavish His Spirit on you and work miracles among you because you practice the law, or because you hear and believe?

⁶So also, “Abraham believed God, and it was credited to him as righteousness.”^a

⁷Understand, then, that those who have faith are sons of Abraham. ⁸The Scripture foresaw that God would justify the Gentiles by faith, and foretold the gospel to Abraham: “All nations will be blessed through you.”^b ⁹So those who have faith are blessed along with Abraham, the man of faith.

Christ Has Redeemed Us

¹⁰All who rely on works of the law are under a curse. For it is written: “Cursed is everyone who does not continue to do everything written in the Book of the Law.”^c ¹¹Now it is clear that no one is justified before God by the law, because, “The righteous will live by faith.”^d ¹²The law, however, is not based on faith; on

the contrary, “The man who does these things will live by them.”^e

¹³Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us. For it is written: “Cursed is everyone who is hung on a tree.”^f ¹⁴He redeemed us in order that the blessing promised to Abraham^g would come to the Gentiles in Christ Jesus, so that by faith we might receive the promise of the Spirit.

The Purpose of the Law

(Romans 7:1–6)

¹⁵Brothers, let me put this in human terms. Even a human covenant, once it is ratified, cannot be canceled or amended.

¹⁶The promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed. The Scripture does not say, “and to seeds,” meaning many, but “and to your seed,”^h meaning One, who is Christ.

¹⁷What I mean is this: The law that came 430 years later does not revoke the covenant previously established by God, so as to nullify the promise. ¹⁸For if the inheritance depends on the law, then it no longer depends on a promise; but God freely granted it to Abraham through a promise.

¹⁹Why then was the law given? It was added because of transgressions, until the arrival of the seed to whom the promise referred. It was administered through angels by a mediator. ²⁰A mediator is unnecessary, however, for only one party; but God is one.

²¹Is the law, then, opposed to the promises of God? Certainly not! For if a law had been given that could impart life, then righteousness would certainly have

^a 3:6 Genesis 15:6

^b 3:8 See Genesis 12:3, Genesis 18:18, and Genesis 22:18.

^c 3:10 Deuteronomy 27:26 (see also LXX)

^d 3:11 Habakkuk 2:4

see also Ezekiel 20:11, 13, and 21.

^f 3:13 Deuteronomy 21:23 (see also LXX)

^g 3:14 Literally *the blessing of Abraham*

^h 3:16 Genesis 12:7; Genesis 13:15

come from the law. ²² But the Scripture pronounces all things confined by sin, so that by faith in Jesus Christ the promise might be given to those who believe.

²³ Before this faith came, we were held in custody under the law, locked up until faith should be revealed. ²⁴ So the law became our guardian to lead us to Christ, that we might be justified by faith. ²⁵ Now that faith has come, we are no longer under a guardian.

Sons through Faith in Christ

²⁶ You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus. ²⁷ For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ. ²⁸ There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus. ²⁹ And if you belong to Christ, then you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise.

Sons and Heirs

4 What I am saying is that as long as the heir is a child, he is no different from a slave, although he is the owner of everything. ² He is subject to guardians and trustees until the date set by his father.

³ So also, when we were children, we were enslaved under the basic principles^a of the world. ⁴ But when the time had fully come, God sent His Son, born of a woman, born under the law, ⁵ to redeem those under the law, that we might receive our adoption as sons. ⁶ And because you are sons, God sent the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, crying out, "Abba, Father!" ⁷ So you are no longer a slave, but a son; and since you are a son, you are also an heir through God.

Paul's Concern for the Galatians

⁸ Formerly, when you did not know God, you were slaves to those who by nature are not gods. ⁹ But now that you know God, or rather are known by God, how is it that you are turning back to those weak and worthless principles? Do you wish to be enslaved by them all over again? ¹⁰ You are observing special days and months and seasons and years! ¹¹ I fear for you, that my efforts for you may have been in vain. ¹² I beg you, brothers, become like me, for I became like you. You have done me no wrong.

¹³ You know that it was because of an illness that I first preached the gospel to you. ¹⁴ And although my illness was a trial to you, you did not despise or reject me. Instead, you welcomed me as if I were an angel of God, as if I were Christ Jesus Himself. ¹⁵ What then has become of your blessing? For I can testify that, if it were possible, you would have torn out your eyes and given them to me. ¹⁶ Have I now become your enemy by telling you the truth?

¹⁷ Those people are zealous for you, but not in a good way. Instead, they want to isolate you from us, so that you may be zealous for them. ¹⁸ Nevertheless, it is good to be zealous if it serves a noble purpose — at any time, and not only when I am with you.

¹⁹ My children, for whom I am again in the pains of childbirth until Christ is formed in you, ²⁰ how I wish I could be with you now and change my tone, because I am perplexed about you.

^a 4:3 Or *elemental forces*; similarly in verse 9

Hagar and Sarah

(Genesis 21:9–21)

²¹ Tell me, you who want to be under the law, do you not understand what the law says? ²² For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by the slave woman and the other by the free woman.^a ²³ His son by the slave woman was born according to the flesh, but his son by the free woman was born through the promise.

²⁴ These things serve as illustrations, for the women represent two covenants. One covenant is from Mount Sinai and bears children into slavery: This is Hagar. ²⁵ Now Hagar stands for Mount Sinai in Arabia and corresponds to the present-day Jerusalem, because she is in slavery with her children. ²⁶ But the Jerusalem above is free, and she is our mother. ²⁷ For it is written:

“Rejoice, O barren woman,
who bears no children;
break forth and cry aloud,
you who have never travailed;
because more are the children of
the desolate woman
than of her who has a husband.”^b

²⁸ Now you,^c brothers, like Isaac, are children of promise. ²⁹ At that time, however, the son born by the flesh persecuted the son born by the Spirit. It is the same now.

³⁰ But what does the Scripture say? “Expel the slave woman and her son, for the slave woman’s son will never share in the inheritance with the free woman’s son.”^d ³¹ Therefore, brothers, we are not children of the slave woman, but of the free woman.

Freedom in Christ

5 It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery.

² Take notice: I, Paul, tell you that if you let yourselves be circumcised, Christ will be of no value to you at all. ³ Again I testify to every man who gets himself circumcised that he is obligated to obey the whole law. ⁴ You who are trying to be justified by the law have been severed from Christ; you have fallen away from grace.

⁵ But by faith we eagerly await through the Spirit the hope of righteousness. ⁶ For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision has any value. What matters is faith expressing itself through love.

⁷ You were running so well. Who has obstructed you from obeying the truth? ⁸ Such persuasion does not come from the One who calls you. ⁹ A little leaven works through the whole batch of dough. ¹⁰ I am confident in the Lord that you will take no other view. The one who is troubling you will bear the judgment, whoever he may be.

¹¹ Now, brothers, if I am still preaching circumcision, why am I still being persecuted? In that case the offense of the cross has been abolished. ¹² As for those who are agitating you, I wish they would proceed to emasculate themselves!

¹³ For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love. ¹⁴ The entire law is fulfilled in a single decree: “Love

^a 4:22 See Genesis 16:15 and Genesis 21:2–3.

^d 4:30 Genesis 21:10

^b 4:27 Isaiah 54:1

^c 4:28 WH, BYZ, and TR we

your neighbor as yourself.”^a ¹⁵But if you keep on biting and devouring one another, watch out, or you will be consumed by one another.

Walking by the Spirit

(*Ezekiel 36:16–38; Romans 8:9–11*)

¹⁶So I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh.

¹⁷For the flesh craves what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are opposed to each other, so that you do not do what you want. ¹⁸But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law.

¹⁹The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity, and debauchery; ²⁰idolatry and sorcery; hatred, discord, jealousy, and rage; rivalries, divisions, factions, ²¹and envy; drunkenness, orgies, and the like. I warn you, as I did before, that those who practice such things will not inherit the kingdom of God.

²²But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, ²³gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

²⁴Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. ²⁵Since we live by the Spirit, let us walk in step with the Spirit. ²⁶Let us not become conceited, provoking and envying one another.

Carry One Another's Burdens

6 Brothers, if someone is caught in a trespass, you who are spiritual should restore him with a spirit of gentleness. But watch yourself, or you also may be tempted. ²Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.

³If anyone thinks he is something when he is nothing, he deceives himself.

⁴Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else. ⁵For each one should carry his own load. ⁶Nevertheless, the one who receives instruction in the word must share in all good things with his instructor.

⁷Do not be deceived: God is not to be mocked. Whatever a man sows, he will reap in return. ⁸The one who sows to please his flesh, from the flesh will reap destruction; but the one who sows to please the Spirit, from the Spirit will reap eternal life.

⁹Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up. ¹⁰Therefore, as we have opportunity, let us do good to everyone, and especially to the family of faith.

Final Warnings and Blessings

¹¹See what large letters I am using to write to you with my own hand!

¹²Those who want to make a good impression outwardly are trying to compel you to be circumcised. They only do this to avoid persecution for the cross of Christ. ¹³For the circumcised do not even keep the law themselves, yet they want you to be circumcised that they may boast in your flesh.

¹⁴But as for me, may I never boast, except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which^b the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. ¹⁵For neither circumcision nor uncircumcision means anything. What counts is a new creation.

¹⁶Peace and mercy to all who walk by this rule, even to the Israel of God.

^a 5:14 Leviticus 19:18 ^b 6:14 Or *through whom*

¹⁷ From now on let no one cause me trouble, for I bear on my body the marks of Jesus.

¹⁸ The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit, brothers.
Amen.

The Letter to the Ephesians

Paul's Greeting to the Ephesians

(Acts 19:8–12; Revelation 2:1–7)

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God,

To the saints in Ephesus,^a the faithful in Christ Jesus:

² Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Spiritual Blessings

(Romans 8:28–34)

³ Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us in Christ with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly realms. ⁴ For He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world to be holy and blameless in His presence. In love ⁵ He predestined us for adoption as His sons through Jesus Christ, according to the good pleasure of His will, ⁶ to the praise of His glorious grace, which He has freely given us in the Beloved One.

⁷ In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace ⁸ that He lavished on us with all wisdom and understanding. ⁹ And He has made known to us the mystery of His will according to His good pleasure, which He purposed in Christ ¹⁰ as a plan for the fullness of time, to bring all things in heaven and on earth together in Christ.

¹¹ In Him we were also chosen as God's own, having been predestined according to the plan of Him who works out everything

by the counsel of His will, ¹² in order that we, who were the first to hope in Christ, would be for the praise of His glory.

¹³ And in Him, having heard and believed the word of truth — the gospel of your salvation — you were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, ¹⁴ who is the pledge of our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God's possession, to the praise of His glory.

Spiritual Wisdom

(1 Corinthians 2:6–16)

¹⁵ For this reason, ever since I heard about your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints, ¹⁶ I have not stopped giving thanks for you, remembering you in my prayers, ¹⁷ that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the glorious Father, may give you a spirit of wisdom and revelation in your knowledge of Him.

¹⁸ I ask that the eyes of your heart^b may be enlightened, so that you may know the hope of His calling, the riches of His glorious inheritance in the saints, ¹⁹ and the surpassing greatness of His power to us who believe. These are in accordance with the working of His mighty strength, ²⁰ which He exerted in Christ when He raised Him from the dead and seated Him at His right hand in the heavenly realms, ²¹ far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in the present age but also in the one to come.

^a 1:1 Some manuscripts do not include in Ephesus.

^b 1:18 TR the eyes of your understanding

²²And God put everything under His feet and made Him head over everything for the church, ²³which is His body, the fullness of Him who fills all in all.

Alive with Christ

(Colossians 2:6–23)

2 And you were dead in your trespasses and sins, ²in which you used to walk when you conformed to the ways of this world and of the ruler of the power of the air, the spirit who is now at work in the sons of disobedience. ³All of us also lived among them at one time, fulfilling the cravings of our flesh and indulging its desires and thoughts. Like the rest, we were by nature children of wrath.

⁴But because of His great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, ⁵made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in our trespasses. It is by grace you have been saved! ⁶And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with Him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus, ⁷in order that in the coming ages He might display the surpassing riches of His grace, demonstrated by His kindness to us in Christ Jesus.

⁸For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹not by works, so that no one can boast. ¹⁰For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life.^a

One in Christ

(Philippians 2:1–4)

¹¹Therefore remember that formerly you who are Gentiles in the flesh and

called uncircumcised by the so-called circumcision (that done in the body by human hands) — ¹²remember that at that time you were separate from Christ, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers to the covenants of the promise, without hope and without God in the world. ¹³But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far away have been brought near through the blood of Christ.

¹⁴For He Himself is our peace, who has made the two one and has torn down the dividing wall of hostility ¹⁵by abolishing in His flesh the law of commandments and decrees. He did this to create in Himself one new man out of the two, thus making peace ¹⁶and reconciling both of them to God in one body through the cross, by which He put to death their hostility.

¹⁷He came and preached peace to you who were far away and peace to those who were near. ¹⁸For through Him we both have access to the Father by one Spirit.

Christ Our Cornerstone

(Isaiah 28:14–22;

1 Corinthians 3:10–15; 1 Peter 2:1–8)

¹⁹Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household, ²⁰built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus Himself as the cornerstone. ²¹In Him the whole building is fitted together and grows into a holy temple in the Lord. ²²And in Him you too are being built together into a dwelling place for God in His Spirit.

^a **2:10** Literally *which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them.*

The Mystery of the Gospel

3 For this reason I, Paul, the prisoner of Christ Jesus for the sake of you Gentiles...^a

² Surely you have heard about the stewardship of God's grace that was given to me for you, ³ that is, the mystery made known to me by revelation, as I have already written briefly. ⁴ In reading this, then, you will be able to understand my insight into the mystery of Christ, ⁵ which was not made known to men in other generations as it has now been revealed by the Spirit to God's holy apostles and prophets. ⁶ This mystery is that through the gospel the Gentiles are fellow heirs, fellow members of the body, and fellow partakers of the promise in Christ Jesus.

⁷ I became a servant of this gospel by the gift of God's grace, given me through the working of His power. ⁸ Though I am less than the least of all the saints, this grace was given me: to preach to the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ, ⁹ and to illuminate for everyone the stewardship^b of this mystery, which for ages past was kept hidden in God, who created all things. ¹⁰ His purpose was that now, through the church, the manifold wisdom of God should be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms, ¹¹ according to the eternal purpose that He accomplished in Christ Jesus our Lord.

¹² In Him and through faith in Him^c we may enter God's presence with boldness and confidence. ¹³ So I ask you not to be discouraged because of my sufferings for you, which are your glory.

Paul's Prayer for the Ephesians

¹⁴ ... for this reason I bow my knees before the Father,^d ¹⁵ from whom every family in heaven and on earth derives its name. ¹⁶ I ask that out of the riches of His glory He may strengthen you with power through His Spirit in your inner being, ¹⁷ so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. Then you, being rooted and grounded in love, ¹⁸ will have power, together with all the saints, to comprehend the length and width and height and depth ¹⁹ of the love of Christ, and to know this love that surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God.

²⁰ Now to Him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to His power that is at work within us, ²¹ to Him be the glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, forever and ever. Amen.

Unity in the Body

(Psalm 133:1–3; 1 Corinthians 1:10–17)

4 As a prisoner in the Lord, then, I urge you to walk in a manner worthy of the calling you have received: ² with all humility and gentleness, with patience, bearing with one another in love, ³ and with diligence to preserve the unity of the Spirit through the bond of peace.

⁴ There is one body and one Spirit, just as you were called to one hope when you were called; ⁵ one Lord, one faith, one baptism; ⁶ one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all.

⁷ Now to each one of us grace has been given according to the measure of the gift of Christ. ⁸ This is why it says:^e

^a 3:1 This train of thought is continued in verse 14. ^b 3:9 NE and WH *and to illuminate the stewardship*; TR *and to illuminate for everyone the fellowship*

^d 3:14 BYZ and TR *before the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ*, ^e 4:8 Or *He says*

^c 3:12 Or *through His faithfulness*

“When He ascended on high,
He led captives away,
and gave gifts to men.”^a

⁹ What does “He ascended” mean, except that He also descended^b to the lower parts of the earth? ¹⁰ He who descended is the very One who ascended above all the heavens, in order to fill all things.

¹¹ And it was He who gave some to be apostles, some to be prophets, some to be evangelists, and some to be pastors and teachers, ¹² to equip the saints for works of ministry and to build up the body of Christ, ¹³ until we all reach unity in the faith and in the knowledge of the Son of God, as we mature to the full measure of the stature of Christ.

¹⁴ Then we will no longer be infants, tossed about by the waves and carried around by every wind of teaching and by the clever cunning of men in their deceitful scheming. ¹⁵ Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head. ¹⁶ From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part.

New Life in Christ

(Colossians 3:1–17)

¹⁷ So I tell you this, and insist on it in the Lord, that you must no longer walk as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their thinking. ¹⁸ They are darkened in their understanding and alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them due to the hardness of their hearts. ¹⁹ Having lost all sense of shame, they have given themselves over to sensuality

for the practice of every kind of impurity, with a craving for more.

²⁰ But this is not the way you came to know Christ. ²¹ Surely you heard of Him and were taught in Him—in keeping with the truth that is in Jesus—²² to put off your former way of life, your old self, which is being corrupted by its deceitful desires; ²³ to be renewed in the spirit of your minds; ²⁴ and to put on the new self, created to be like God in true righteousness and holiness.

²⁵ Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another. ²⁶ “Be angry, yet do not sin.”^c Do not let the sun set upon your anger, ²⁷ and do not give the devil a foothold.

²⁸ He who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work, doing good with his own hands, that he may have something to share with the one in need.

²⁹ Let no unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building up the one in need and bringing grace to those who listen.

³⁰ And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, in whom you were sealed for the day of redemption.

³¹ Get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, outcry and slander, along with every form of malice. ³² Be kind and tenderhearted to one another, forgiving each other just as in Christ God forgave you.

Imitators of God

5 Be imitators of God, therefore, as beloved children, ² and walk in love, just as Christ loved us^d and gave Himself up for us as a fragrant sacrificial offering to God.

^a 4:8 Psalm 68:18 ^b 4:9 BYZ and TR *except that He also descended first* ^c 4:26 Or “In your anger do not sin.” Psalm 4:4 ^d 5:2 NE and WH *Christ loved you*

³But among you, as is proper among the saints, there must not be even a hint of sexual immorality, or of any kind of impurity, or of greed. ⁴Nor should there be obscenity, foolish talk, or crude joking, which are out of character, but rather thanksgiving. ⁵For of this you can be sure: No immoral, impure, or greedy person (that is, an idolater) has any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.

⁶Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of such things the wrath of God is coming on the sons of disobedience. ⁷Therefore do not be partakers with them.

Children of Light

⁸For you were once darkness, but now you are light in the Lord. Walk as children of light, ⁹for the fruit of the light consists in all goodness, righteousness, and truth. ¹⁰Test and prove what pleases the Lord.

¹¹Have no fellowship with the fruitless deeds of darkness, but rather expose them. ¹²For it is shameful even to mention what the disobedient do in secret. ¹³But everything exposed by the light becomes visible,^a for everything that is illuminated becomes a light itself. ¹⁴So it is said:

“Wake up, O sleeper,
rise up from the dead,
and Christ will shine on you.”

¹⁵Pay careful attention, then, to how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, ¹⁶redeeming the time, because the days are evil. ¹⁷Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the Lord’s will is. ¹⁸Do not get drunk on wine, which leads to reckless indiscretion. Instead, be filled with the Spirit.

¹⁹Speak to one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. Sing and make music in your hearts to the Lord, ²⁰always giving thanks to God the Father for everything in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Wives and Husbands

(*Song of Solomon 1:1–17; 1 Peter 3:1–7*)

²¹Submit to one another out of reverence for Christ.^b

²²Wives, submit to your husbands as to the Lord. ²³For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church, His body, of which He is the Savior. ²⁴Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything.

²⁵Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave Himself up for her ²⁶to sanctify her, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word, ²⁷and to present her to Himself as a glorious church, without stain or wrinkle or any such blemish, but holy and blameless.

²⁸In the same way, husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself. ²⁹Indeed, no one ever hated his own body, but he nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ does the church. ³⁰For we are members of His body.^c

³¹“For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.”^d ³²This mystery is profound, but I am speaking about Christ and the church. ³³Nevertheless, each one of you also must love his wife as he loves himself, and the wife must respect her husband.

^a 5:13 SBL begins verse 14 after *visible*, ^b 5:21 Or *in the fear of Christ*. ^c 5:30 BYZ and TR include *—of His flesh and of His bones*. ^d 5:31 Genesis 2:24 (see also LXX)

Children and Parents

(*Colossians 3:18–21*)

6 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right. ²“Honor your father and mother” (which is the first commandment with a promise), ³“that it may go well with you and that you may have a long life on the earth.”^a

⁴Fathers, do not provoke your children to wrath; instead, bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord.

Serving with Honor

(*Colossians 3:22–25; 1 Timothy 6:1–2*)

⁵Slaves, obey your earthly masters with respect and fear and sincerity of heart, just as you would obey Christ. ⁶And do this not only to please them while they are watching, but as servants of Christ, doing the will of God from your heart. ⁷Serve with good will, as to the Lord and not to men, ⁸because you know that the Lord will reward each one for whatever good he does, whether he is slave or free.

⁹And masters, do the same for your slaves. Give up your use of threats, because you know that He who is both their Master and yours is in heaven, and there is no favoritism with Him.

The Full Armor of God

¹⁰Finally, be strong in the Lord and in His mighty power. ¹¹Put on the full armor of God, so that you can make your stand against the devil’s schemes. ¹²For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world’s darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms.

¹³Therefore take up the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you will be able to stand your ground, and having done everything, to stand. ¹⁴Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness arrayed, ¹⁵and with your feet fitted with the readiness of the gospel of peace. ¹⁶In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one. ¹⁷And take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God.

¹⁸Pray in the Spirit at all times, with every kind of prayer and petition. To this end, stay alert with all perseverance in your prayers for all the saints. ¹⁹Pray also for me, that whenever I open my mouth, words may be given me so that I will boldly make known the mystery of the gospel, ²⁰for which I am an ambassador in chains. Pray that I may proclaim it fearlessly, as I should.

Final Greetings

(*Philippians 4:21–23; 2 Timothy 4:19–22*)

²¹Tychicus, the beloved brother and faithful servant in the Lord, will tell you everything, so that you also may know about me and what I am doing. ²²I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know about us, and that he may encourage your hearts.

²³Peace to the brothers and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

²⁴Grace to all who love our Lord Jesus Christ with an undying love.

^a 6:3 Exodus 20:12; Deuteronomy 5:16

The Letter to the Philippians

Greetings from Paul and Timothy

(Colossians 1:1–2; Philemon 1:1–3)

1 Paul and Timothy, servants of Christ Jesus,

To all the saints in Christ Jesus at Philippi, together with the overseers and deacons:

² Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Thanksgiving and Prayer

(1 Corinthians 1:4–9; Colossians 1:3–14)

³ I thank my God every time I remember you. ⁴ In every prayer for all of you, I always pray with joy, ⁵ because of your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now, ⁶ being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus.

⁷ It is right for me to feel this way about all of you, since I have you in my heart. For in my chains and in my defense and confirmation of the gospel, you are all partners in grace with me. ⁸ God is my witness how I long for all of you with the affection of Christ Jesus.

⁹ And this is my prayer: that your love may abound more and more in knowledge and depth of insight, ¹⁰ so that you may be able to test and prove what is best and may be pure and blameless for the day of Christ, ¹¹ filled with the fruit of

righteousness that comes through Jesus Christ, to the glory and praise of God.

Paul's Trials Advance the Gospel

(James 1:2–12)

¹² Now I want you to know, brothers, that my circumstances have actually served to advance the gospel. ¹³ As a result, it has become clear throughout the whole palace guard^a and to everyone else that I am in chains for Christ. ¹⁴ And most of the brothers, confident in the Lord by my chains, now dare more greatly to speak the word^b without fear.

¹⁵ It is true that some preach Christ out of envy and rivalry, but others out of goodwill. ¹⁶ The latter do so in love, knowing that I am appointed for the defense of the gospel.^c ¹⁷ The former, however, preach Christ out of selfish ambition, not sincerely, supposing that they can add to the distress of my chains.

¹⁸ What then is the issue?^d Just this: that in every way, whether by false motives or true, Christ is preached. And in this I rejoice. Yes, and I will continue to rejoice, ¹⁹ because I know that through your prayers and the provision of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, my distress will turn out for my deliverance. ²⁰ I eagerly expect and hope that I will in no way be ashamed, but will have complete boldness so that now as always Christ will be exalted in my body, whether by life or by death.

^a 1:13 Or *all the Praetorium*
order of verses 16 and 17.

^b 1:14 NE and WH *the word of God*
^d 1:18 Literally *What then?*

^c 1:16 BYZ and TR reverse the

To Live Is Christ

²¹For to me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain. ²²But if I go on living in the body, this will mean fruitful labor for me. So what shall I choose? I do not know. ²³I am torn between the two. I desire to depart and be with Christ, which is far better indeed. ²⁴But it is more necessary for you that I remain in the body.

²⁵Convinced of this, I know that I will remain and will continue with all of you for your progress and joy in the faith, ²⁶so that through my coming to you again your exultation in Christ Jesus will resound on account of me.

Worthy of the Gospel

²⁷Nevertheless, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see you or only hear about you in my absence, I will know that you stand firm in one spirit, contending together as one^a for the faith of the gospel, ²⁸without being frightened in any way by those who oppose you. This is a clear sign of their destruction but of your salvation, and it is from God. ²⁹For it has been granted to you on behalf of Christ not only to believe in Him, but also to suffer for Him, ³⁰since you are encountering the same struggle you saw I had, and now hear that I still have.

One in Christ

(*Ephesians 2:11–18*)

2 Therefore if you have any encouragement in Christ, if any comfort from His love, if any fellowship with the Spirit, if any affection and compassion, ²then make my joy complete

by being like-minded, having the same love, being united in spirit and purpose.

³Do nothing out of selfish ambition or empty pride, but in humility consider others more important than yourselves.

⁴Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others.

The Mind of Christ

(*Isaiah 52:13–15*)

⁵Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus:

⁶Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped,^b

⁷but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in human likeness.

⁸And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to death — even death on a cross.

⁹Therefore God exalted Him to the highest place and gave Him the name above all names,

¹⁰that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth,

¹¹and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

Lights in the World

(*Matthew 5:13–16*)

¹²Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed, not only in my

^a 1:27 Or *striving together with one mind* ^b 2:6 Or *something to be exploited*

presence, but now even more in my absence, continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling.¹³ For it is God who works in you to will and to act on behalf of His good purpose.

¹⁴ Do everything without complaining or arguing,¹⁵ so that you may be blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a crooked and perverse generation,^a in which you shine as lights in the world¹⁶ as you hold forth the word of life, in order that I may boast on the day of Christ that I did not run or labor in vain.

¹⁷ But even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of you.¹⁸ So you too should be glad and rejoice with me.

Timothy and Epaphroditus

(1 Corinthians 16:10–12)

¹⁹ Now I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered when I learn how you are doing.²⁰ I have nobody else like him who will genuinely care for your needs.²¹ For all the others look after their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ.²² But you know Timothy's proven worth, that as a child with his father he has served with me to advance the gospel.²³ So I hope to send him as soon as I see what happens with me.²⁴ And I trust in the Lord that I myself will come soon.

²⁵ But I thought it necessary to send back to you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow worker, and fellow soldier, who is also your messenger and minister to my needs.²⁶ For he has been longing for all of you and is distressed because you heard he was ill.²⁷ He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and

not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow.

²⁸ Therefore I am all the more eager to send him, so that when you see him again you may rejoice, and I may be less anxious.²⁹ Welcome him in the Lord with great joy, and honor men like him,³⁰ because he nearly died for the work of Christ, risking his life to make up for your deficit of service to me.

Righteousness through Faith in Christ

(Romans 3:21–31)

3 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord. It is no trouble for me to write the same things to you again, and it is a safeguard for you.

² Watch out for those dogs, those workers of evil, those mutilators of the flesh!³ For it is we who are the circumcision, we who worship by the Spirit of God, who glory in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh — ⁴ though I myself could have such confidence.

If anyone else thinks he has grounds for confidence in the flesh, I have more:⁵ circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin; a Hebrew of Hebrews; as to the law, a Pharisee;⁶ as to zeal, persecuting the church; as to righteousness in the law, faultless.

⁷ But whatever was gain to me I count as loss for the sake of Christ.⁸ More than that, I count all things as loss compared to the surpassing excellence of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord, for whom I have lost all things. I consider them rubbish, that I may gain Christ⁹ and be found in Him, not having my own righteousness from the law, but that which is through

^a 2:15 Deuteronomy 32:5

faith in Christ,^a the righteousness from God on the basis of faith.

¹⁰ I want to know Christ and the power of His resurrection and the fellowship of His sufferings, being conformed to Him in His death,¹¹ and so, somehow, to attain to the resurrection from the dead.

Pressing on toward the Goal

¹² Not that I have already obtained all this, or have already been made perfect, but I press on to take hold of that for which Christ Jesus took hold of me. ¹³ Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, ¹⁴ I press on toward the goal to win the prize of God's heavenly calling in Christ Jesus.

¹⁵ All of us who are mature should embrace this point of view. And if you think differently about some issue, God will reveal this to you as well.

¹⁶ Nevertheless, we must live up to what we have already attained.

Citizenship in Heaven

¹⁷ Join one another in following my example, brothers, and carefully observe those who walk according to the pattern we set for you. ¹⁸ For as I have often told you before, and now say again even with tears: Many live as enemies of the cross of Christ. ¹⁹ Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things.

²⁰ But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, ²¹ who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to

Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body.

Rejoice in the Lord

4 Therefore, my brothers, whom I love and long for, my joy and crown, that is how you must stand firm in the Lord, my beloved.

² I urge Euodia and Syntyche to agree with each other in the Lord. ³ Yes, and I ask you, my true yokefellow,^b to help these women who have contended at my side for the gospel, along with Clement and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the Book of Life.

⁴ Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! ⁵ Let your gentleness be apparent to all. The Lord is near.

⁶ Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. ⁷ And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

⁸ Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable — if anything is excellent or praiseworthy — think on these things. ⁹ Whatever you have learned or received or heard from me, or seen in me, put it into practice. And the God of peace will be with you.

The Generosity of the Philippians

(2 Corinthians 8:1–15)

¹⁰ Now I rejoice greatly in the Lord that at last you have revived your concern for me. You were indeed concerned, but you had no opportunity to show it. ¹¹ I am not saying this out of need, for I

^a 3:9 Or *through the faithfulness of Christ* ^b 4:3 Or *I ask you, loyal Syzygus*

have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances. ¹²I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. In any and every situation I have learned the secret of being filled and being hungry, of having plenty and having need. ¹³I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.^a

¹⁴Nevertheless, you have done well to share in my affliction. ¹⁵And as you Philippians know, in the early days of the gospel, when I left Macedonia, no church but you partnered with me in the matter of giving and receiving. ¹⁶For even while I was in Thessalonica, you provided for my needs again and again.

¹⁷Not that I am seeking a gift, but I am looking for the fruit that may be credited to your account. ¹⁸I have all I

need and more, now that I have received your gifts from Epaphroditus. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, well-pleasing to God.

¹⁹And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus. ²⁰To our God and Father be glory forever and ever. Amen.

Final Greetings

(*Ephesians 6:21–24; 2 Timothy 4:19–22*)

²¹Greet all the saints in Christ Jesus.

The brothers who are with me send you greetings.

²²All the saints send you greetings, especially those from the household of Caesar.

²³The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.^b

^a 4:13 NA, SBL, NE, and WH in the *One who gives me strength*. BYZ and TR in *Christ who gives me strength*.

^b 4:23 BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The Letter to the Colossians

Greetings from Paul and Timothy

(*Philippians 1:1–2; Philemon 1:1–3*)

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and Timothy our brother,
²To the saints and faithful brothers in Christ at Colossae:

Grace and peace to you from God our Father.^a

Thanksgiving and Prayer

(*1 Corinthians 1:4–9; Philippians 1:3–11*)

³We always thank God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, when we pray for you,
⁴because we have heard about your faith in Christ Jesus and your love for all the saints — ⁵the faith and love proceeding from the hope stored up for you in heaven, of which you have already heard in the word of truth, the gospel ⁶that has come to you.

All over the world this gospel is bearing fruit and growing, just as it has been doing among you since the day you heard it and truly understood the grace of God. ⁷You learned it from Epaphras, our beloved fellow servant, who is a faithful minister of Christ on our^b behalf, ⁸and who also informed us of your love in the Spirit.

⁹For this reason, since the day we heard about you, we have not stopped praying for you and asking God to fill you with the knowledge of His will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, ¹⁰so that you may walk in a manner worthy of the Lord

and may please Him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God, ¹¹being strengthened with all power according to His glorious might so that you may have full endurance and patience, and joyfully ¹²giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you^c to share in the inheritance of the saints in the light.

¹³He has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of His beloved Son, ¹⁴in whom we have redemption,^d the forgiveness of sins.

The Supremacy of the Son

(*Hebrews 1:1–14*)

¹⁵The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. ¹⁶For in Him all things were created, things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities. All things were created through Him and for Him.

¹⁷He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together. ¹⁸And He is the head of the body, the church; He is the beginning and firstborn from among the dead, so that in all things He may have preeminence. ¹⁹For God was pleased to have all His fullness dwell in Him, ²⁰and through Him to reconcile to Himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven, by making peace through the blood of His cross.

^a 1:2 BYZ and TR *God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ*

^b 1:7 NE, NA, BYZ, and TR *your*

^c 1:12 BYZ and TR *us* ^d 1:14 TR *redemption through His blood*,

²¹ Once you were alienated from God and were hostile in your minds, engaging in evil deeds. ²² But now He has reconciled you by Christ's physical body through death to present you holy, unblemished, and blameless in His presence — ²³ if indeed you continue in your faith, established and firm, not moved from the hope of the gospel you heard, which has been proclaimed to every creature^a under heaven, and of which I, Paul, have become a servant.

Paul's Suffering for the Church

(2 Corinthians 11:16–33)

²⁴ Now I rejoice in my sufferings for you, and I fill up in my flesh what is lacking in regard to Christ's afflictions for the sake of His body, which is the church. ²⁵ I became its servant by the commission God gave me to fully proclaim to you the word of God, ²⁶ the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations but is now revealed to His saints. ²⁷ To them God has chosen to make known among the Gentiles the glorious riches of this mystery, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory.

²⁸ We proclaim Him, admonishing and teaching everyone with all wisdom, so that we may present everyone perfect^b in Christ. ²⁹ To this end I also labor, striving with all His energy working powerfully within me.

Absent in Body, Present in Spirit

(Revelation 3:14–22)

2 For I want you to know how much I am struggling for you and for those at Laodicea, and for all who have not met me face to face, ² that they may be encouraged in heart, knit together in love,

and filled with the full riches of complete understanding, so that they may know the mystery of God, namely Christ,^{c 3} in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.

⁴ I say this so that no one will deceive you by smooth rhetoric. ⁵ For although I am absent from you in body, I am present with you in spirit, and I delight to see your orderly condition and firm faith in Christ.

Alive with Christ

(Ephesians 2:1–10)

⁶ Therefore, just as you have received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to walk in Him, ⁷ rooted and built up in Him, established in the faith as you were taught, and overflowing with thankfulness.

⁸ See to it that no one takes you captive through philosophy and empty deception, which are based on human tradition and the spiritual forces of the world rather than on Christ. ⁹ For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity dwells in bodily form. ¹⁰ And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority.

¹¹ In Him you were also circumcised, in the putting off of your sinful nature, with the circumcision performed by Christ^d and not by human hands. ¹² And having been buried with Him in baptism, you were raised with Him through your faith in the power of God, who raised Him from the dead.

¹³ When you were dead in your trespasses and in the uncircumcision of your sinful nature, God made you alive with Christ. He forgave us all our trespasses, ¹⁴ having canceled the debt

^a 1:23 Or *in all creation* ^b 1:28 Or *fully mature* ^c 2:2 Literally *the mystery of God: Christ*
^d 2:11 Literally *in the cutting away of the body of the flesh, by the circumcision of Christ*

ascribed to us in the decrees that stood against us. He took it away, nailing it to the cross! ¹⁵ And having disarmed the powers and authorities, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross.

¹⁶ Therefore let no one judge you by what you eat or drink, or with regard to a feast, a New Moon, or a Sabbath. ¹⁷ These are a shadow of the things to come, but the body that casts it belongs to Christ.^a ¹⁸ Do not let anyone who delights in false humility and the worship of angels disqualify you with speculation about what he has seen. Such a person is puffed up without basis by his unspiritual mind. ¹⁹ He has lost connection to the head, from whom the whole body, supported and knit together by its joints and ligaments, grows as God causes it to grow.

²⁰ If you have died with Christ to the spiritual forces of the world, why, as though you still belonged to the world, do you submit to its regulations: ²¹ “Do not handle, do not taste, do not touch!”? ²² These will all perish with use, because they are based on human commands and teachings. ²³ Such restrictions indeed have an appearance of wisdom, with their self-prescribed worship, their false humility, and their harsh treatment of the body; but they are of no value against the indulgence of the flesh.

Put On the New Self

(Ephesians 4:17–32)

3 Therefore, since you have been raised with Christ, strive for the things above, where Christ is seated at the right hand of God. ² Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things. ³ For you

died, and your life is now hidden with Christ in God. ⁴ When Christ, who is your^b life, appears, then you also will appear with Him in glory.

⁵ Put to death, therefore, the components of your earthly nature: sexual immorality, impurity, lust, evil desires, and greed, which is idolatry. ⁶ Because of these, the wrath of God is coming on the sons of disobedience.^c ⁷ When you lived among them, you also used to walk in these ways. ⁸ But now you must put aside all such things as these: anger, rage, malice, slander, and filthy language from your lips.

⁹ Do not lie to one another, since you have taken off the old self with its practices, ¹⁰ and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge in the image of its Creator. ¹¹ Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all.

¹² Therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, clothe yourselves with hearts of compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience. ¹³ Bear with one another and forgive any complaint you may have against someone else. Forgive as the Lord forgave you. ¹⁴ And over all these virtues put on love, which is the bond of perfect unity. ¹⁵ Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, for to this you were called as members of one body. And be thankful.

¹⁶ Let the word of Christ richly dwell within you as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom, and as you sing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs with gratitude in your hearts to God. ¹⁷ And whatever you do, in word or deed, do it

^a 2:17 Literally *but the body is of the Christ* ^b 3:4 NE, WH, BYZ, and TR *our* ^c 3:6 NE, WH, and Tischendorf do not include *on the sons of disobedience*.

all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through Him.

Christian Households

(Ephesians 6:1–4)

¹⁸ Wives, submit to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord.

¹⁹ Husbands, love your wives and do not be harsh with them.

²⁰ Children, obey your parents in everything, for this is pleasing to the Lord.

²¹ Fathers, do not provoke your children, so they will not become discouraged.

Serving with Honor

(Ephesians 6:5–9; 1 Timothy 6:1–2)

²² Slaves, obey your earthly masters in everything, not only to please them while they are watching, but with sincerity of heart and fear of the Lord.

²³ Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, as for the Lord and not for men, ²⁴ because you know that you will receive an inheritance from the Lord as your reward. It is the Lord Christ you are serving. ²⁵ Whoever does wrong will be repaid for his wrong, and there is no favoritism.

Prayerful Speech and Actions

4 Masters, supply your slaves with what is right and fair, since you know that you also have a Master in heaven.

² Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful, ³ as you pray also for us, that God may open to us a door for the word, so that we may proclaim the mystery of Christ, for which I am in chains. ⁴ Pray that I may declare it clearly, as I should.

⁵ Act wisely toward outsiders, redeeming the time. ⁶ Let your speech always be

gracious, seasoned with salt, so that you may know how to answer everyone.

Greetings from Paul's Fellow Workers

(Romans 16:21–23)

⁷ Tychicus will tell you all the news about me. He is a beloved brother, a faithful minister, and a fellow servant in the Lord.

⁸ I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know about us, and that he may encourage your hearts.

⁹ With him I am sending Onesimus, our faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They will tell you about everything here.

¹⁰ My fellow prisoner Aristarchus sends you greetings, as does Mark the cousin of Barnabas. You have already received instructions about him: If he comes to you, welcome him. ¹¹ Jesus, who is called Justus, also sends greetings. These are the only Jews among my fellow workers for the kingdom of God, and they have been a comfort to me.

¹² Epaphras, who is one of you and a servant of Christ Jesus, sends you greetings. He is always wrestling in prayer for you, so that you may stand mature and fully assured in the full will of God. ¹³ For I testify about him that he goes to great pains for you and for those at Laodicea and Hierapolis.

¹⁴ Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings.

Signature and Final Instructions

(1 Corinthians 16:19–24;

2 Thessalonians 3:16–18)

¹⁵ Greet the brothers in Laodicea, as well as Nympha and the church that meets at her house.

¹⁶ After this letter has been read among you, make sure that it is also read in the

church of the Laodiceans, and that you in turn read the letter from Laodicea.

¹⁷ Tell Archippus: “See to it that you complete the ministry you have received in the Lord.”

¹⁸ This greeting is in my own hand — Paul.

Remember my chains.

Grace be with you.^a

^a **4:18** BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The First Letter to the Thessalonians

Greetings to the Thessalonians

(2 Thessalonians 1:1–4)

1 Paul, Silvanus,^a and Timothy,
To the church of the Thessalonians in
God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:
Grace and peace to you.^b

²We always thank God for all of you,
remembering you in our prayers ³and
continually recalling before our God and
Father your work of faith, your labor of
love, and your enduring hope in our Lord
Jesus Christ.

⁴Brothers who are beloved by God, we
know that He has chosen you, ⁵because
our gospel came to you not only in word,
but also in power, in the Holy Spirit, and
with great conviction — just as you know
we lived among you for your sake. ⁶And
you became imitators of us and of the
Lord when you welcomed the message
with the joy of the Holy Spirit, in spite of
your great suffering.

⁷As a result, you have become an
example to all the believers in Macedonia
and Achaia. ⁸For not only did the message
of the Lord ring out from you to Macedonia
and Achaia, but your faith in God has gone
out to every place, so that we have no
need to say anything more. ⁹For they
themselves report what kind of welcome
you gave us, and how you turned to God
from idols to serve the living and true
God ¹⁰and to await His Son from heaven,

whom He raised from the dead — Jesus
our deliverer from the coming wrath.

Paul's Ministry

2 You yourselves know, brothers, that
our visit to you was not in vain.
²As you are aware, we had already
endured suffering and shameful treatment
in Philippi. But in the face of strong
opposition, we were bold in our God to
speak to you the gospel of God.

³For our appeal does not arise from
deceit or ulterior motives or trickery.

⁴Instead, we speak as those approved by
God to be entrusted with the gospel, not
in order to please men but God, who
examines our hearts. ⁵As you know, we
never used words of flattery or any pretext
for greed. God is our witness! ⁶Nor did
we seek praise from you or from anyone
else, although as apostles of Christ we had
authority to demand it.^c

⁷On the contrary, we were gentle among
you,^d like a nursing mother caring for her
children. ⁸We cared so deeply that we
were delighted to share with you not
only the gospel of God, but our own lives
as well. That is how beloved you have
become to us.

⁹Surely you recall, brothers, our labor
and toil. We worked night and day so
that we would not be a burden to anyone
while we proclaimed to you the gospel of
God. ¹⁰You are witnesses, and so is God,
of how holy, righteous, and blameless our

^a 1:1 That is, Silas ^b 1:1 BYZ and TR include *from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ*. ^c 2:6 Or *although as apostles of Christ we could have been a burden to you*; SBL, NE, and WH include this phrase with verse 7. ^d 2:7 WH and NA *we were like young children among you*

conduct was among you who believed.

¹¹For you know that we treated each of you as a father treats his own children—¹²encouraging you, comforting you, and urging you to walk in a manner worthy of God, who calls you into His own kingdom and glory.

¹³And we continually thank God because, when you received the word of God that you heard from us, you accepted it not as the word of men, but as it truly is, the word of God, which is also now at work in you who believe.

¹⁴For you, brothers, became imitators of the churches of God in Judea that are in Christ Jesus. You suffered from your own countrymen the very things they suffered from the Jews, ¹⁵who killed both the Lord Jesus and their own prophets and drove us out as well. They are displeasing to God and hostile to all men, ¹⁶hindering us from telling the Gentiles how they may be saved. As a result, they continue to heap up their sins to full capacity; the utmost wrath has come upon them.^a

Paul's Longing to Visit

¹⁷Brothers, although we were torn away from you for a short time (in person, not in heart), our desire to see you face to face was even more intense. ¹⁸For we wanted to come to you — indeed I, Paul, tried again and again — but Satan obstructed us. ¹⁹After all, who is our hope, our joy, our crown of boasting, if it is not you yourselves in the presence of our Lord Jesus at His coming? ²⁰You are indeed our glory and our joy.

Timothy's Visit

3 So when we could bear it no longer, we were willing to be left on our own in Athens. ²We sent Timothy, our brother and fellow worker for God^b in the gospel of Christ, to strengthen and encourage you in your faith, ³so that none of you would be shaken by these trials. For you know that we are destined for this. ⁴Indeed, when we were with you, we kept warning you that we would suffer persecution; and as you know, it has come to pass. ⁵For this reason, when I could bear it no longer, I sent to find out about your faith, for fear that the tempter had somehow tempted you and that our labor might have been in vain.

Timothy's Encouraging Report

⁶But just now, Timothy has returned from his visit with the good news about your faith, your love, and the fond memories you have preserved, longing to see us just as we long to see you. ⁷For this reason, brothers, in all our distress and persecution, we have been reassured about you, because of your faith. ⁸For now we can go on living, as long as you are standing firm in the Lord.

⁹How can we adequately thank God for you in return for our great joy over you in His presence? ¹⁰Night and day we pray most earnestly that we may see you face to face and supply what is lacking in your faith.

¹¹Now may our God and Father Himself, and our Lord Jesus, direct our way to you. ¹²And may the Lord cause you to increase and overflow with love for one another and for everyone else, just as our love for

^a 2:16 Or at last the wrath (of God) has come upon them.

^b 3:2 Or our brother and God's fellow worker; NE, WH, BYZ, and TR our brother and minister of God

you overflows, ¹³so that He may establish your hearts in blamelessness and holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all His saints. Amen.

Living to Please God

4 Finally, brothers, we ask and encourage you in the Lord Jesus to live in a way that is pleasing to God, just as you have received from us. This is how you already live, so you should do so all the more. ²For you know the instructions we gave you by the authority of the Lord Jesus.

³For it is God's will that you should be holy: You must abstain from sexual immorality; ⁴each of you must know how to control his own body^a in holiness and honor, ⁵not in lustful passion like the Gentiles who do not know God; ⁶and no one should ever violate or exploit his brother in this regard,^b because the Lord will avenge all such acts, as we have already told you and solemnly warned you. ⁷For God has not called us to impurity, but to holiness. ⁸Anyone, then, who rejects this command does not reject man but God, the very One who gives you His Holy Spirit.

⁹Now about brotherly love, you do not need anyone to write to you, because you yourselves have been taught by God to love one another. ¹⁰And you are indeed showing this love to all the brothers throughout Macedonia. But we urge you, brothers, to excel more and more ¹¹and to aspire to live quietly, to attend to your own matters, and to work with your own hands, as we instructed you. ¹²Then you will behave properly toward outsiders, without being dependent on anyone.

The Return of the Lord

¹³Brothers, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death,^c so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope. ¹⁴For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, we also believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him.

¹⁵By the word of the Lord, we declare to you that we who are alive and remain until the coming of the Lord will by no means precede those who have fallen asleep. ¹⁶For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a loud command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will be the first to rise. ¹⁷After that, we who are alive and remain will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will always be with the Lord.

¹⁸Therefore encourage one another with these words.

The Day of the Lord

(Zephaniah 1:7–18;

Malachi 4:1–6; 2 Peter 3:8–13)

5 Now about the times and seasons, brothers, we do not need to write to you. ²For you are fully aware that the Day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night. ³While people are saying, “Peace and security,” destruction will come upon them suddenly, like labor pains on a pregnant woman, and they will not escape.

⁴But you, brothers, are not in the darkness so that this day should overtake you like a thief. ⁵For you are all sons of

^a 4:4 Literally *know how to possess his own vessel* ^b 4:6 Or *no one should ever harm or cheat his brother in this matter* ^c 4:13 Literally *those who have fallen asleep*, as in verses 14 and 15

the light and sons of the day; we do not belong to the night or to the darkness.⁶ So then, let us not sleep as the others do, but let us remain awake and sober.⁷ For those who sleep, sleep at night, and those who get drunk, get drunk at night.⁸ But since we belong to the day, let us be sober, putting on the breastplate of faith and love, and the helmet of our hope of salvation.

⁹ For God has not appointed us to suffer wrath, but to obtain salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ. ¹⁰ He died for us so that, whether we are awake or asleep, we may live together with Him. ¹¹ Therefore encourage and build one another up, just as you are already doing.

Christian Living

¹² But we ask you, brothers, to acknowledge those who work diligently among you, who care for you in the Lord and who admonish you. ¹³ In love, hold them in highest regard because of their work. Live in peace with one another.

¹⁴ And we urge you, brothers, to admonish the unruly, encourage the

fainthearted, help the weak, and be patient with everyone.

¹⁵ Make sure that no one repays evil for evil. Always pursue what is good for one another and for all people.

¹⁶ Rejoice at all times. ¹⁷ Pray without ceasing. ¹⁸ Give thanks in every circumstance, for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus.

¹⁹ Do not extinguish the Spirit. ²⁰ Do not treat prophecies with contempt, ²¹ but test all things. Hold fast to what is good. ²² Abstain from every form of evil.

Final Blessings and Instructions

²³ Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely, and may your entire spirit, soul, and body be kept blameless^a at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. ²⁴ The One who calls you is faithful, and He will do it.

²⁵ Brothers, pray for us as well.

²⁶ Greet all the brothers with a holy kiss.

²⁷ I charge you before the Lord to have this letter read to all the brothers.

²⁸ The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.^b

^a 5:23 Or *may your spirit, soul, and body be kept entirely blameless* ^b 5:28 BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The Second Letter to the **Thessalonians**

Greetings to the Thessalonians

(1 Thessalonians 1:1–10)

1 Paul, Silvanus,^a and Timothy,
To the church of the Thessalonians in
God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:

²Grace and peace to you from God our
Father^b and the Lord Jesus Christ.

³We are obligated to thank God for
you all the time, brothers, as is fitting,
because your faith is growing more and
more, and your love for one another is
increasing. ⁴That is why we boast among
God's churches about your perseverance
and faith in the face of all the persecution
and affliction you are enduring.

Christ's Coming

⁵All this is clear evidence of God's
righteous judgment. And so you will be
counted worthy of the kingdom of God,
for which you are suffering. ⁶After all, it is
only right for God to repay with affliction
those who afflict you, ⁷and to grant relief
to you who are oppressed and to us as
well. This will take place when the Lord
Jesus is revealed from heaven with His
mighty angels ⁸in blazing fire, inflicting
vengeance on those who do not know
God and do not obey the gospel of our
Lord Jesus. ⁹They will suffer the penalty
of eternal destruction, separated from the
presence of the Lord and the glory of
His might, ¹⁰on the day He comes to
be glorified in His saints and regarded

with wonder by all who have believed,
including you who have believed our
testimony.

¹¹To this end, we always pray for you,
that our God will count you worthy of
His calling, and that He will powerfully
fulfill your every good desire and work
of faith, ¹²so that the name of our Lord
Jesus will be glorified in you, and you in
Him, according to the grace of our God
and of the Lord Jesus Christ.^c

The Man of Lawlessness

2 Now concerning the coming of our
Lord Jesus Christ and our being
gathered together to Him, we ask you,
brothers, ²not to be easily disconcerted
or alarmed by any spirit or message or
letter seeming to be from us, alleging that
the Day of the Lord has already come.
³Let no one deceive you in any way, for
it will not come until the rebellion occurs
and the man of lawlessness — the son of
destruction — is revealed. ⁴He will oppose
and exalt himself above every so-called
god or object of worship. So he will seat
himself in the temple of God, proclaiming
himself to be God.

⁵Do you not remember that I told you
these things while I was still with you?
⁶And you know what is now restraining
him, so that he may be revealed at
the proper time. ⁷For the mystery of
lawlessness is already at work, but the
one who now restrains it will continue

^a 1:1 That is, Silas ^b 1:2 SBL, NE, and WH *God the Father* ^c 1:12 Or *the grace of our God and Lord, Jesus Christ*.

until he is taken out of the way.⁸ And then the lawless one will be revealed, whom the Lord Jesus will slay with the breath of His mouth and annihilate by the majesty of His arrival.

⁹The coming of the lawless one will be accompanied by the working of Satan, with every kind of power, sign, and false wonder,¹⁰ and with every wicked deception directed against those who are perishing, because they refused the love of the truth that would have saved them.¹¹ For this reason God will send them a powerful delusion so that they believe the lie,¹² in order that judgment may come upon all who have disbelieved the truth and delighted in wickedness.

Stand Firm

¹³But we should always thank God for you, brothers who are loved by the Lord, because God chose you from the beginning^a to be saved by the sanctification of the Spirit and by faith in the truth.¹⁴ To this He called you through our gospel, so that you may share in the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.¹⁵ Therefore, brothers, stand firm and cling to the traditions we taught you, whether by speech or by letter.

¹⁶Now may our Lord Jesus Christ Himself and God our Father, who by grace has loved us and given us eternal comfort and good hope,¹⁷ encourage your hearts and strengthen you in every good word and deed.

Request for Prayer

3 Finally, brothers, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may spread quickly and be held in honor, just as it was with you.² And pray that we may be

delivered from wicked and evil men; for not everyone holds to the faith.³ But the Lord is faithful, and He will strengthen you and guard you from the evil one.^b⁴ And we have confidence in the Lord that you are doing and will continue to do what we command.⁵ May the Lord direct your hearts into God's love and Christ's perseverance.

A Warning against Idleness

⁶Now we command you, brothers, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, to keep away from any brother who leads an undisciplined life that is not in keeping with the tradition you received^c from us.⁷ For you yourselves know how you ought to imitate us, because we were not undisciplined among you,⁸ nor did we eat anyone's food without paying for it. Instead, in labor and toil, we worked night and day so that we would not be a burden to any of you.⁹ Not that we lack this right, but we wanted to offer ourselves as an example for you to imitate.¹⁰ For even while we were with you, we gave you this command: "If anyone is unwilling to work, he shall not eat."

¹¹For we hear that some of you are leading undisciplined lives, accomplishing nothing, but being busybodies.¹² We command and urge such people by our Lord Jesus Christ to begin working quietly to earn their own living.¹³ But as for you, brothers, do not grow weary in well-doing.

¹⁴Take note of anyone who does not obey the instructions we have given in this letter. Do not associate with him, so that he may be ashamed.¹⁵ Yet do not regard him as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.

^a 2:13 Or *God has chosen you as the firstfruits* ^b 3:3 Or *from evil* ^c 3:6 Or *they received*

Signature and Final Greetings*(1 Corinthians 16:19–24; Colossians 4:15–18)*

¹⁶Now may the Lord of peace Himself give you peace at all times and in every way. The Lord be with all of you.

¹⁷This greeting is in my own hand — Paul. This is my mark in every letter; it is the way I write.

¹⁸The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with all of you.^a

^a **3:18** BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The First Letter to

Timothy

Paul's Greeting to Timothy

(2 Timothy 1:1–2)

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the command of God our Savior and of Christ Jesus our hope,

²To Timothy, my true child in the faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

Correcting False Teachers

(Titus 1:10–16)

³As I urged you on my departure to Macedonia, you should stay on at Ephesus to instruct certain men not to teach false doctrines ⁴or devote themselves to myths and endless genealogies, which promote speculation rather than the stewardship of God's work, which is by faith.^a

⁵The goal of our instruction is the love that comes from a pure heart, a clear conscience, and a sincere faith. ⁶Some have strayed from these ways and turned aside to empty talk. ⁷They want to be teachers of the law, but they do not understand what they are saying or that which they so confidently assert.

⁸Now we know that the law is good, if one uses it legitimately. ⁹We realize that law is not enacted for the righteous, but for the lawless and rebellious, for the ungodly and sinful, for the unholy and profane, for killers of father or mother, for murderers,¹⁰ for the sexually immoral, for homosexuals, for slave traders^b and liars

and perjurers, and for anyone else who is averse to sound teaching ¹¹that agrees with the glorious gospel of the blessed God, with which I have been entrusted.

God's Grace to Paul

¹²I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who has strengthened me, that He considered me faithful and appointed me to service. ¹³I was formerly a blasphemer, a persecutor, and a violent man; yet because I had acted in ignorance and unbelief, I was shown mercy. ¹⁴And the grace of our Lord overflowed to me, along with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus.

¹⁵This is a trustworthy saying, worthy of full acceptance: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the worst. ¹⁶But for this very reason I was shown mercy, so that in me, the worst of sinners, Christ Jesus might display His perfect patience as an example to those who would believe in Him for eternal life. ¹⁷Now to the King eternal, immortal, and invisible, the only God, be honor and glory forever and ever. Amen.

¹⁸Timothy, my child, I entrust you with this command in keeping with the previous prophecies about you, so that by them you may fight the good fight, ¹⁹holding on to faith and a good conscience, which some have rejected and thereby shipwrecked their faith. ²⁰Among them are Hymenaeus and Alexander, whom I have handed over to Satan to be taught not to blaspheme.

^a 1:4 Literally *rather than the stewardship of God in faith* ^b 1:10 Or *for kidnappers*

A Call to Prayer

2 First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone—²for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity. ³This is good and pleasing in the sight of God our Savior, ⁴who wants everyone to be saved and to come to the knowledge of the truth.

⁵For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, ⁶who gave Himself as a ransom for all — the testimony that was given at just the right time.

⁷For this reason I was appointed as a preacher, an apostle, and a faithful and true teacher of the Gentiles. I am telling the truth; I am not lying about anything. ⁸Therefore I want the men everywhere^a to pray, lifting up holy hands, without anger or dissension.

Instructions to Women

⁹Likewise, I want the women to adorn themselves with respectable apparel, with modesty, and with self-control, not with braided hair or gold or pearls or expensive clothes,¹⁰ but with good deeds, as is proper for women who profess to worship God.

¹¹A woman^b must learn in quietness and full submissiveness. ¹²I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man;^c she is to remain quiet. ¹³For Adam was formed first, and then Eve. ¹⁴And it was not Adam who was deceived, but the woman who was deceived and fell into transgression. ¹⁵Women, however, will be saved^d through childbearing, if

they continue in faith, love, and holiness, with self-control.

Qualifications for Overseers

(Titus 1:5–9; 1 Peter 5:1–4)

3 This is a trustworthy saying: If anyone aspires to be an overseer, he desires a noble task. ²An overseer, then, must be above reproach, the husband of but one wife,^e temperate, self-controlled, respectable, hospitable, able to teach, ³not dependent on wine, not violent but gentle, peaceable, and free of the love of money.

⁴An overseer must manage his own household well and keep his children under control, with complete dignity. ⁵For if someone does not know how to manage his own household, how can he care for the church of God? ⁶He must not be a recent convert, or he may become conceited and fall under the same condemnation as the devil. ⁷Furthermore, he must have a good reputation with outsiders, so that he will not fall into disgrace and into the snare of the devil.

Qualifications for Deacons

(Acts 6:1–7)

⁸Deacons likewise must be dignified, not double-tongued or given to much wine or greedy for money. ⁹They must hold to the mystery of the faith with a clear conscience. ¹⁰Additionally, they must first be tested. Then, if they are above reproach, let them serve as deacons.

¹¹In the same way, the women^f must be dignified, not slanderers, but temperate and faithful in all things.

¹²A deacon must be the husband of but one wife, a good manager of his children

^a 2:8 Or in every place (of worship) ^b 2:11 Or wife; also in verse 12 ^c 2:12 Or over her husband

^d 2:15 Literally She, however, will be saved ^e 3:2 Or faithful to his wife; also in verse 12 ^f 3:11 Or their wives

and of his own household. ¹³For those who have served well as deacons acquire for themselves a high standing and great confidence in the faith that is in Christ Jesus.

The Mystery of Godliness

¹⁴Although I hope to come to you soon, I am writing you these things ¹⁵in case I am delayed, so that you will know how each one must conduct himself in God's household, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and foundation of the truth.

¹⁶By common confession, the mystery of godliness is great:

He appeared^a in the flesh,
 was vindicated by the Spirit,^b
 was seen by angels,
 was proclaimed among the nations,
 was believed in throughout the world,
 was taken up in glory.

A Warning against Apostasy

4 Now the Spirit expressly states that in later times some will abandon the faith to follow deceitful spirits and the teachings of demons, ²influenced by the hypocrisy of liars, whose consciences are seared with a hot iron.

³They will prohibit marriage and require abstinence from certain foods that God has created to be received with thanksgiving by those who believe and know the truth.

⁴For every creation of God is good, and nothing that is received with thanksgiving should be rejected, ⁵because it is sanctified by the word of God and prayer.

A Good Servant of Jesus Christ

⁶By pointing out these things to the brothers, you will be a good servant of Christ Jesus, nourished by the words of faith and sound instruction that you have followed.

⁷But reject irreverent, silly myths. Instead, train yourself for godliness. ⁸For physical exercise is of limited value, but godliness is valuable in every way, holding promise for the present life and for the one to come. ⁹This is a trustworthy saying, worthy of full acceptance.

¹⁰To this end we labor and strive,^c because we have set our hope on the living God, who is the Savior of everyone, and especially of those who believe.

¹¹Command and teach these things.

¹²Let no one despise your youth, but set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith, in purity.

¹³Until I come, devote yourself to the public reading of Scripture, to exhortation, and to teaching.

¹⁴Do not neglect the gift that is in you, which was given you through the prophecy spoken over you at the laying on of the hands of the elders. ¹⁵Be diligent in these matters and absorbed in them, so that your progress will be evident to all. ¹⁶Pay close attention to your life and to your teaching. Persevere in these things, for by so doing you will save both yourself and those who hear you.

Reproof and Respect

5 Do not rebuke an older man, but appeal to him as to a father.

^a 3:16 Literally *He who appeared*; BYZ and TR *God appeared* ^b 3:16 Or *vindicated in spirit* ^c 4:10 SBL, BYZ, and TR *and suffer reproach*

Treat younger men as brothers, ²older women as mothers, and younger women as sisters, with absolute purity.

Honoring True Widows

(Ruth 1:1–5)

³Honor the widows who are truly widows. ⁴But if a widow has children or grandchildren, they must first learn to show godliness to their own family and repay their parents, for this is pleasing in the sight of God.

⁵The widow who is truly in need and left all alone puts her hope in God and continues night and day in her petitions and prayers. ⁶But she who lives for pleasure is dead even while she is still alive.

⁷Give these instructions to the believers, so that they will be above reproach. ⁸If anyone does not provide for his own, and especially his own household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.

⁹A widow should be enrolled if she is at least sixty years old, faithful to her husband, ¹⁰and well known for good deeds such as bringing up children, entertaining strangers, washing the feet of the saints, imparting relief to the afflicted, and devoting herself to every good work.

¹¹But refuse to enroll younger widows. For when their passions draw them away from Christ, they will want to marry, ¹²and thus will incur judgment because they are setting aside their first faith. ¹³At the same time they will also learn to be idle, going from house to house and being not only idle, but also gossips and busybodies, discussing things they should not mention.

¹⁴So I advise the younger widows to marry, have children, and manage their households, denying the adversary occasion for slander. ¹⁵For some have already turned aside to follow Satan.

¹⁶If any believing woman has dependent widows, she must assist them and not allow the church to be burdened, so that it can help the widows who are truly in need.

Honoring Elders

¹⁷Elders who lead effectively are worthy of double honor, especially those who work hard at preaching and teaching.

¹⁸For the Scripture says, “Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain,”^a and, “The worker is worthy of his wages.”^b

¹⁹Do not entertain an accusation against an elder, except on the testimony of two or three witnesses. ²⁰But those who persist in sin should be rebuked in front of everyone, so that the others will stand in fear of sin.

A Charge to Timothy

²¹I solemnly charge you before God and Christ Jesus and the elect angels to maintain these principles without bias, and to do nothing out of partiality.

²²Do not be too quick in the laying on of hands and thereby share in the sins of others. Keep yourself pure.

²³Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments.

²⁴The sins of some men are obvious, going ahead of them to judgment; but the sins of others do not surface until later. ²⁵In the same way, good deeds are obvious, and even the ones that are inconspicuous cannot remain hidden.

^a 5:18 Deuteronomy 25:4 ^b 5:18 Luke 10:7; see also Leviticus 19:13 and Deuteronomy 24:14–15.

Serving with Honor

(Ephesians 6:5–9; Colossians 3:22–25)

6 All who are under the yoke of slavery should regard their masters as fully worthy of honor, so that God's name and our teaching will not be discredited. ²Those who have believing masters should not show disrespect because they are brothers, but should serve them all the more, since those receiving their good service are beloved believers. Teach and encourage these principles.

Reject False Doctrines

³If anyone teaches another doctrine and disagrees with the sound words of our Lord Jesus Christ and with godly teaching, ⁴he is conceited and understands nothing. Instead, he has an unhealthy interest in controversies and disputes about words, out of which come envy, strife, abusive talk, evil suspicions, ⁵and constant friction between men of depraved mind who are devoid of the truth. These men regard godliness as a means of gain.^a

Godliness with Contentment

⁶Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain. ⁷For we brought nothing into the world, so^b we cannot carry anything out of it. ⁸But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with these.

⁹Those who want to be rich, however, fall into temptation and become ensnared by many foolish and harmful desires that plunge them into ruin and destruction. ¹⁰For the love of money is the root of all kinds of evil. By craving it, some have wandered away from the faith and pierced themselves with many sorrows.

Fight the Good Fight

¹¹But you, O man of God, flee from these things and pursue righteousness, godliness, faith, love, perseverance, and gentleness. ¹²Fight the good fight of the faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called when you made the good confession before many witnesses.

¹³I charge you in the presence of God, who gives life to all things, and of Christ Jesus, who made the good confession in His testimony before Pontius Pilate: ¹⁴Keep this commandment without stain or reproach until the appearance of our Lord Jesus Christ, ¹⁵which the blessed and only Sovereign One— the King of kings and Lord of lords— will bring about in His own time. ¹⁶He alone is immortal and dwells in unapproachable light. No one has ever seen Him, nor can anyone see Him. To Him be honor and eternal dominion! Amen.

A Charge to the Rich

(Proverbs 23:1–5; James 5:1–6)

¹⁷Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. ¹⁸Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, ¹⁹treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life.

Guard the Faith

²⁰O Timothy, guard what has been entrusted to you. Avoid irreverent, empty chatter and the opposing arguments of so-called “knowledge,” ²¹which some

^a 6:5 BYZ and TR include *Withdraw yourself from such.* ^b 6:7 BYZ and TR *so certainly*

have professed and thus swerved away | Grace be with you all.^a
from the faith.

^a **6:21** BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The Second Letter to Timothy

Paul's Greeting to Timothy

(1 Timothy 1:1–2)

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, according to the promise of life in Christ Jesus,

²To Timothy, my beloved child:

Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

Faithfulness under Persecution

(Matthew 10:16–25)

³I thank God, whom I serve with a clear conscience as did my forefathers, as I constantly remember you night and day in my prayers. ⁴Recalling your tears, I long to see you so that I may be filled with joy.

⁵I am reminded of your sincere faith, which first dwelt in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice, and I am convinced is in you as well.

⁶For this reason I remind you to fan into flame the gift of God, which is in you through the laying on of my hands. ⁷For God has not given us a spirit of fear,^a but of power, love, and self-control.

⁸So do not be ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, or of me, His prisoner. Instead, join me in suffering for the gospel by the power of God. ⁹He has saved us and called us to a holy calling, not because of our works, but by His own purpose and by the

grace He granted us in Christ Jesus before time began.^b ¹⁰And now He has revealed this grace through the appearing of our Savior, Christ Jesus, who has abolished death and illuminated the way to life and immortality through the gospel, ¹¹to which I was appointed as a preacher, an apostle, and a teacher.

¹²For this reason, even though I suffer as I do, I am not ashamed; for I know whom I have believed, and I am convinced that He is able to guard what I have entrusted to Him^c for that day.

Holding to Sound Teaching

¹³Hold on to the pattern of sound teaching^d you have heard from me, with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus.

¹⁴Guard the treasure entrusted to you,^e with the help of the Holy Spirit who dwells in us.

¹⁵You know that everyone in the Province of Asia^f has deserted me, including Phygelus and Hermogenes.

¹⁶May the Lord grant mercy to the household of Onesiphorus, because he has often refreshed me and was unashamed of my chains. ¹⁷Indeed, when he arrived in Rome, he searched diligently until he found me.

¹⁸May the Lord grant Onesiphorus His mercy on that day. You know very well how much he ministered to me in Ephesus.

^a 1:7 Or timidity or cowardice ^b 1:9 Literally before times eternal ^c 1:12 Or what He has entrusted to me ^d 1:13 Literally sound words ^e 1:14 Or the good deposit entrusted to you ^f 1:15 Literally in Asia; Asia was a Roman province in what is now western Turkey.

Grace and Perseverance

(Hebrews 12:1–3)

2 You therefore, my child, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus. ²And the things that you have heard me say among many witnesses, entrust these to faithful men who will be qualified to teach others as well.

³Join me in suffering, like a good soldier of Christ Jesus. ⁴A soldier refrains from entangling himself in civilian affairs, in order to please the one who enlisted him. ⁵Likewise, a competitor does not receive the crown unless he competes according to the rules. ⁶The hardworking farmer should be the first to partake of the crops. ⁷Consider what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all things.

⁸Remember Jesus Christ, raised from the dead, descended from David, as proclaimed by my gospel, ⁹for which I suffer to the extent of being chained like a criminal. But the word of God cannot be chained! ¹⁰For this reason I endure all things for the sake of the elect, so that they too may obtain the salvation that is in Christ Jesus, with eternal glory.

¹¹This is a trustworthy saying:

If we died with Him,
we will also live with Him;
¹²if we endure,
we will also reign with Him;
if we deny Him,
He will also deny us;
¹³if we are faithless,
He remains faithful,
for He cannot deny Himself.

The Lord's Approved Workman

¹⁴Remind the believers of these things, charging them before God^a to avoid quarreling over words, which succeeds only in leading the listeners to ruin.

¹⁵Make every effort to present yourself approved to God, an unashamed workman who accurately handles the word of truth.

¹⁶But avoid irreverent, empty chatter, which will only lead to more ungodliness, ¹⁷and the talk of such men will spread like gangrene. Among them are Hymenaeus and Philetus, ¹⁸who have deviated from the truth. They say that the resurrection has already occurred, and they undermine the faith of some.

¹⁹Nevertheless, God's firm foundation stands, bearing this seal: "The Lord knows those who are His,"^b and, "Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord must turn away from iniquity."

²⁰A large house contains not only vessels of gold and silver, but also of wood and clay. Some indeed are for honorable use, but others are for common use. ²¹So if anyone cleanses himself of what is unfit,^c he will be a vessel for honor: sanctified, useful to the Master, and prepared for every good work.

²²Flee from youthful passions and pursue righteousness, faith, love, and peace, together with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart.

²³But reject foolish and ignorant speculation, for you know that it breeds quarreling. ²⁴And a servant of the Lord must not be quarrelsome, but must be kind to everyone, able to teach, and forbearing. ²⁵He must gently reprove those who oppose him, in the hope that

^a 2:14 SBL, BYZ, and TR *the Lord himself of these*

^b 2:19 Numbers 16:5 (see also LXX)

^c 2:21 Literally *cleanses*

God may grant them repentance leading to a knowledge of the truth.²⁶ Then they will come to their senses and escape the snare of the devil, who has taken them captive to his will.

Evil in the Last Days

3 But understand this: In the last days terrible times will come.² For men will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boastful, arrogant, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy,³ unloving, unforgiving, slanderous, without self-control, brutal, without love of good,⁴ traitorous, reckless, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God,⁵ having a form of godliness but denying its power. Turn away from such as these!

⁶ They are the kind who worm their way into households and captivate vulnerable women who are weighed down with sins and led astray by various passions,⁷ who are always learning but never able to come to a knowledge of the truth.

⁸ Just as Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses,^a so also these men oppose the truth. They are depraved in mind and disqualified from the faith.⁹ But they will not advance much further. For just like Jannes and Jambres, their folly will be plain to everyone.

All Scripture Is God-Breathed

(Hebrews 4:12–16)

¹⁰ You, however, have observed my teaching, my conduct, my purpose, my faith, my patience, my love, my perseverance,¹¹ my persecutions, and the sufferings that came upon me in Antioch, Iconium, and Lystra. What persecutions I

endured! Yet the Lord rescued me from all of them.¹² Indeed, all who desire to live godly lives in Christ Jesus will be persecuted,¹³ while evil men and imposters go from bad to worse, deceiving and being deceived.

¹⁴ But as for you, continue in the things you have learned and firmly believed, since you know from whom you have learned them.¹⁵ From infancy you have known the Holy Scriptures, which are able to make you wise for salvation through faith in Christ Jesus.¹⁶ All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for instruction, for conviction, for correction, and for training in righteousness,¹⁷ so that the man of God may be complete, fully equipped for every good work.

Preach the Word

4 I charge you in the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of His appearing and His kingdom: ² Preach the word; be prepared in season and out of season; reprove, rebuke, and encourage with every form of patient instruction.

³ For the time will come when men will not tolerate sound doctrine, but with itching ears they will gather around themselves teachers to suit their own desires.⁴ So they will turn their ears away from the truth and turn aside to myths.

⁵ But you, be sober in all things, endure hardship, do the work of an evangelist, fulfill your ministry.⁶ For I am already being poured out like a drink offering, and the time of my departure is at hand.⁷ I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.⁸ From now on there is laid up for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord,

^a 3:8 See Jasher 79:27. *The Book of Jasher* or *the Book of the Upright One* is often cited as *Jasher*.

the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day — and not only to me, but to all who crave His appearing.

Personal Concerns

⁹Make every effort to come to me quickly, ¹⁰because Demas, in his love of this world, has deserted me and gone to Thessalonica. Crescens has gone to Galatia, and Titus to Dalmatia. ¹¹Only Luke is with me. Get Mark and bring him with you, because he is useful to me in the ministry. ¹²Tychicus, however, I have sent to Ephesus. ¹³When you come, bring the cloak that I left with Carpus at Troas, and my scrolls, especially the parchments.

¹⁴Alexander the coppersmith did great harm to me. The Lord will repay him according to his deeds. ¹⁵You too should beware of him, for he has vigorously opposed our message.

The Lord Remains Faithful

¹⁶At my first defense, no one stood with me, but everyone deserted me. May it not

be charged against them. ¹⁷But the Lord stood by me and strengthened me, so that through me the message would be fully proclaimed, and all the Gentiles would hear it. So I was delivered from the mouth of the lion. ¹⁸And the Lord will rescue me from every evil action and bring me safely into His heavenly kingdom. To Him be the glory forever and ever. Amen.

Final Greetings

(*Ephesians 6:21–24; Philippians 4:21–23*)

¹⁹Greet Prisca^a and Aquila, as well as the household of Onesiphorus.

²⁰Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus.

²¹Make every effort to come to me before winter.

Eubulus sends you greetings, as do Pudens, Linus, Claudia, and all the brothers.

²²The Lord be with your spirit. Grace be with you all.^b

^a 4:19 *Prisca* is a variant of *Priscilla*; see Acts 18:2.

^b 4:22 BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The Letter to Titus

Paul's Greeting to Titus

(2 Corinthians 8:16–24)

1 Paul, a servant of God and an apostle of Jesus Christ for the faith of God's elect and their knowledge of the truth that leads to godliness, ²in the hope of eternal life, which God, who cannot lie, promised before time began.^a ³In His own time He has made His word evident in the proclamation entrusted to me by the command of God our Savior.

⁴To Titus, my true child in our common faith:

Grace and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Savior.

Appointing Elders on Crete

(1 Timothy 3:1–7; 1 Peter 5:1–4)

⁵The reason I left you in Crete was that you would set in order what was unfinished and appoint elders in every town, as I directed you. ⁶An elder must be blameless, the husband of but one wife,^b having children who are believers and who are not open to accusation of indiscretion or insubordination.

⁷As God's steward, an overseer must be above reproach — not self-willed, not quick-tempered, not given to drunkenness, not violent, not greedy for money. ⁸Instead, he must be hospitable, a lover of good, self-controlled, upright, holy, and disciplined. ⁹He must hold firmly to the faithful word as it was taught, so that he

can encourage others by sound teaching and refute those who contradict it.

Correcting False Teachers

(1 Timothy 1:3–11)

¹⁰For many are rebellious and full of empty talk and deception, especially those of the circumcision, ¹¹who must be silenced. For the sake of dishonorable gain, they undermine entire households and teach things they should not. ¹²As one of their own prophets has said, "Cretans are always liars, evil beasts, lazy gluttons."^c

¹³This testimony is true. Therefore rebuke them sternly, so that they will be sound in the faith ¹⁴and will pay no attention to Jewish myths or to the commands of men who have rejected the truth.

¹⁵To the pure, all things are pure; but to the defiled and unbelieving, nothing is pure. Indeed, both their minds and their consciences are defiled. ¹⁶They profess to know God, but by their actions they deny Him. They are detestable, disobedient, and unfit for any good deed.

Teaching Sound Doctrine

2 But as for you, speak the things that are consistent with sound doctrine.

²Older men are to be temperate, dignified, self-controlled, and sound in faith, love, and perseverance.

³Older women, likewise, are to be reverent in their behavior, not slanderers

^a 1:2 Literally *before times eternal* ^b 1:6 Or *faithful to his wife* ^c 1:12 This quote, also known as the Epimenides paradox, has been attributed to the Cretan philosopher Epimenides of Knossos.

or addicted to much wine, but teachers of good. ⁴In this way they can train the young women to love their husbands and children, ⁵to be self-controlled, pure, managers of their households, kind, and submissive to their own husbands, so that the word of God will not be discredited.

⁶In the same way, urge the younger men to be self-controlled.

⁷In everything, show yourself to be an example by doing good works. In your teaching show integrity, dignity, ⁸and wholesome speech that is above reproach, so that anyone who opposes us will be ashamed, having nothing bad to say about us.

⁹Slaves are to submit to their own masters in everything, to be well-pleasing, not argumentative, ¹⁰not stealing from them, but showing all good faith, so that in every respect they will adorn the teaching about God our Savior.

God's Grace Brings Salvation

¹¹For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to everyone. ¹²It instructs us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live sensible, upright, and godly lives in the present age, ¹³as we await the blessed hope and glorious appearance of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ. ¹⁴He gave Himself for us to redeem us from all lawlessness and to purify for Himself a people for His own possession, zealous for good deeds.

¹⁵Speak these things as you encourage and rebuke with all authority. Let no one despise you.

Heirs of Grace

3 Remind the believers to submit to rulers and authorities, to be obedient

and ready for every good work, ²to malign no one, and to be peaceable and gentle, showing full consideration to everyone.

³For at one time we too were foolish, disobedient, misled, and enslaved to all sorts of desires and pleasures — living in malice and envy, being hated and hating one another.

⁴But when the kindness of God our Savior and His love for mankind appeared, ⁵He saved us, not by the righteous deeds we had done, but according to His mercy, through the washing of new birth^a and renewal by the Holy Spirit. ⁶This is the Spirit He poured out on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Savior, ⁷so that, having been justified by His grace, we would become heirs with the hope of eternal life. ⁸This saying is trustworthy. And I want you to emphasize these things, so that those who have believed God will take care to devote themselves to good deeds. These things are excellent and profitable for the people.

Avoid Divisions

(Romans 16:17–20)

⁹But avoid foolish controversies, genealogies, arguments, and quarrels about the law, because these things are pointless and worthless.

¹⁰Reject a divisive man after a first and second admonition, ¹¹knowing that such a man is corrupt and sinful; he is self-condemned.

Final Remarks and Greetings

¹²As soon as I send Artemas or Tychicus to you, make every effort to come to me at Nicopolis, because I have decided to winter there. ¹³Do your best to equip Zenas the lawyer and Apollos, so that they will have

^a 3:5 Or of regeneration

everything they need. ¹⁴And our people must also learn to devote themselves to good works in order to meet the pressing needs of others, so that they will not be unfruitful.

¹⁵All who are with me send you greetings.

Greet those who love us in the faith.

Grace be with all of you.^a

^a **3:15** BYZ and TR include *Amen*.

The Letter to Philemon

Greetings from Paul and Timothy

(*Philippians 1:1–2; Colossians 1:1–2*)

1 Paul, a prisoner of Christ Jesus, and Timothy our brother,

To Philemon our beloved fellow worker,
²to Apphia our sister, to Archippus our fellow soldier, and to the church that meets at your^a house:

³Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Philemon's Faith and Love

⁴I always thank my God, remembering you in my prayers, ⁵because I hear about your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints. ⁶I pray that your partnership in the faith may become effective as you fully acknowledge every good thing that is ours in Christ. ⁷I take great joy and encouragement in your love, because you, brother, have refreshed the hearts of the saints.

Paul's Appeal for Onesimus

⁸So although in Christ I am bold enough to order you to do what is proper, ⁹I prefer to appeal on the basis of love. For I, Paul, am now aged, and a prisoner of Christ Jesus as well.

¹⁰I appeal to you for my child Onesimus,^b whose father I became while I was in chains. ¹¹Formerly he was useless

to you, but now he has become useful both to you and to me. ¹²I am sending back to you him who is my very heart.

¹³I would have liked to keep him with me, so that on your behalf he could minister to me in my chains for the gospel. ¹⁴But I did not want to do anything without your consent, so that your goodness will not be out of compulsion, but by your own free will. ¹⁵For perhaps this is why he was separated from you for a while, so that you might have him back for good — ¹⁶no longer as a slave, but better than a slave, as a beloved brother. He is especially beloved to me, but even more so to you, both in person and in the Lord.

¹⁷So if you consider me a partner, receive him as you would receive me. ¹⁸But if he has wronged you in any way or owes you anything, charge it to my account. ¹⁹I, Paul, write this with my own hand. I will repay it— not to mention that you owe me your very self.

²⁰Yes, brother, let me have some benefit^c from you in the Lord. Refresh my heart in Christ.

²¹Confident of your obedience, I write to you, knowing that you will do even more than I ask.

²²In the meantime, prepare a guest room for me, because I hope that through your prayers I will be restored to you.

^a **1:2** *You* and *Your* are singular throughout this letter, except in verses 3, 22, and 25. ^b **1:10** *Onesimus* means *useful* (see verse 11) or *beneficial* (see verse 20). ^c **1:20** Greek *onaimēn*, a play on the name *Onesimus*

Additional Greetings

²³ Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in Christ Jesus, sends you greetings, ²⁴ as do Mark,

Aristarchus, Demas, and Luke, my fellow workers.

²⁵ The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.^a

^a **1:25** BYZ and TR include *Amen*.